Diana Nalivaiko

Burnaby, BC • diana_nalivaiko@sfu.ca • (604) 312-5372

Portfolio • LinkedIn • GitHub

Education

Bachelor of Science, Interactive Arts and Technology — MAY 2026 – EXPECTED JANUARY 2028
Simon Fraser University — **Burnaby, BC**

Associate of Science, Computer Science — JANUARY 2023 – JANUARY 2025
Langara College — **Vancouver, BC**

Credits towards Bachelor of Science in Physics — SEPTEMBER 2018 – MAY 2021
Belarusian State University — **Minsk, Belarus**

Skills

3D Visualization: Modeling (Blender) • Texturing (Adobe Substance 3D Painter, 3DCoat) • Rendering • UV Mapping • Custom Materials • Sculpting • Optimization • Asset Integration (Unity, React Three Fiber)

Development: OOP • C++ • Python • JavaScript • HTML • CSS • React Three Fiber • React • Git • R • SQL • MATLAB

Other: Linear Algebra • Game Design • UI/UX Design • Figma • Management • Customer Support • Collaboration

Work Experience

3D Environment Artist — JUNE 2025 – AUGUST 2025
Kazuo Corporation | Vancouver, BC

- Designed modular, low-poly Blender assets in an anime-inspired style, optimized for mobile, allowing components to be reused throughout the game.
- Created custom stylized textures in 3DCoat to achieve an anime look while balancing visual quality with mobile performance constraints.
- Integrated Blender assets in Unity using the game's custom shader to ensure textures matched the anime-inspired art style and rendered cleanly.

3D Art Instructor — DECEMBER 2021 – JANUARY 2023
Fungi Studio | Remote

- Designed an original 3D art curriculum in Blender, Substance 3D Painter, and 3DCoat for students ages 9–14, enabling every student to complete 2 finished, textured 3D models.
- Facilitated hands-on lessons that broke down complex 3D concepts, helping students build problem-solving skills and create portfolio-ready work.
- Retained over 90% of students through a 4-month program by guiding them step by step through the full 3D art pipeline, from modeling to texturing.

Research Assistant — SEPTEMBER 2020 – MAY 2021
Belarusian State University | Minsk, Belarus

- Modeled how potential drug molecules bind to target proteins using 3D docking software (RosettaDock, GRAMM-X), then analyzed energy plots of 1,000 simulated structures to identify the most likely successful interactions.
- Presented findings at a student research conference, contributing to a first-place team finish.

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Technical Projects

Diana's Coffee Shop | GitHub — AUGUST 2026
IAT 265: Multimedia Programming for Art and Design

- Designed the game concept, user interface, and custom visual assets for a Java desktop barista simulator, translating the gameplay concept into an interactive visual experience.
- Developed the game in Java using object-oriented class structures and Java Swing, implementing interactive gameplay and UI functionality.
- Implemented a finite state machine alongside Factory and Decorator design patterns to create modular game systems and manage gameplay state transitions.

VizWorld (nwPlus Choice Award) | Devpost — MARCH 2025
cmd-f 2025 Hackathon | Vancouver, BC

- Collaborated with three teammates to design and develop the UI and front-end of an AI-powered language-learning web app for children in under 24 hours.
- Designed, modeled, and textured an interactive 3D mascot in Blender and 3DCoat, creating a friendly visual guide for users to rotate and explore.
- Integrated the custom 3D mascot into the web app using React Three Fiber and Three.js, optimizing textures and lighting for smooth real-time rendering.

Torch Factory (Most Popular on Sketchfab Award) | Sketchfab — SEPTEMBER 2020
Minsk, Belarus

- Created an optimized, game-ready 3D scene in Blender using hard-surface modeling techniques to achieve clean topology and efficient geometry.
- Designed unique hand-painted textures in 3DCoat using custom UV maps to achieve a 2D cartoon style on 3D models.
- Translated 2D concept art into a cohesive 3D scene, interpreting the illustrator's visual direction through modeling and texturing.

Additional Experience

Barista — APRIL 2025 – APRIL 2026
Trees Organic Coffee – Renfrew | Vancouver, BC

- Supported new location openings by setting up inventory, coordinating supply orders, and testing equipment.
- Onboarded and trained staff on drinks and store procedures, independently managed solo shifts while preparing espresso drinks and latte art.

Volunteer Physics Mentor — SEPTEMBER 2018 – PRESENT
International Young Physicists' Tournament | Remote

- Mentor high school students in experimental physics and research methodology through problem-solving discussions, strengthening research and analytical skills.
- Prepare students through mock tournaments and presentation practice, guiding the team to a 3rd-place finish at a national physics competition.